is totally immersed in hot oil and cooked. The temperature maintained is 180°–220°C (eg.) Samosa, Bajji, etc. The taste of the food is improved along with texture.

Merits:

1. Very quick method of cooking.
2. The calorific value of food is increased as fat is the medium of cooking.
3. It gives a delicious flavour and appearance to the food.
4. Taste and texture are improved.

Demerits:

1. Constant monitoring is needed to prevent scorching.
2. The food may become soggy due to too much fat absorption.
3. Fried foods are not easily digested.
4. Repeated use of heated oils will have ill effects on health.

3.5.3 Combination Method

i) Braising

Braising is a combined method of roasting and stewing in a pan with a tight fitting lid. Meat is cooked by this method.

Examples of foods cooked by braising are:

1. Uppuma : Roasting and boiling
2. Cutlet : Boiling and shallow frying.
3. Vermicelli payasam : Roasting and simmering.

3.5.4 Innovative Methods

i) Microwave Cooking

Electromagnetic waves from a power source called magnetron are absorbed by the food and food becomes hot at once. Microwave cooking enhances the flavour of food because it cooks quickly with little or no water and thus preserves the natural colour of vegetables and fruits.



▲ Fig 4 Microwave oven

Merits:

1. Quick method – 10 times faster than the conventional method. So loss of nutrients can be minimized.
2. Only the food gets heated and the oven does not get heated.
3. Foods get heated uniformly.
4. Leftovers can be reheated without changing the flavor and texture of the product.
5. Microwave cooking enhances the flavor of the food because it cooks quickly with little or no water.

Demerits:

1. Baked products do not develop a brown surface.
2. Microwave cooking cannot be used for simmering, deep frying or stewing.
3. Flavour of all ingredients do not blend well as the cooking time is too short.

ii) Solar Cooking

Solar cooker works on solar energy. Solar cooker consists of well insulated box, the inside of which is painted dull black and

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